



However, not all MFPs include the PC fax function, which allows faxing documents directly from the PC without having to print them first. MFPs can have the PC Fax feature as a fax utility, as a fax driver that you use like a print driver, or both.

Most of the MFPs today come with flatbed scanners, which are good for scanning photos or single sheet documents. But an automatic document feeder (ADF) helps users easily scan, copy, fax and email multi-page documents. An ADF also lets you scan legal-sized pages in MFPs with letter-size flatbeds. However, not all MFPs offer this; so be sure to check if that is a feature you require.

If you deal with two-sided documents, an ADF offering duplex scan (for both sides of a page) is an apt choice.

3. Cost/value benefits: For an IT admin, knowing the total cost of ownership is extremely important. While

evaluating the TCO of a multi-functional printer, just the initial cost of the hardware is not the only consideration. There are a number of other factors that should be considered, including the cost of supplies. After evaluating the ink costs, the inkjet multifunction printers tend to cost much more than the higher performing laser and solid ink multi-function printers. The TCO for MFPs that are hard to use and maintain is comparatively higher. So check this aspect thoroughly before you invest in a device.

4. Multi-tasking abilities: An MFP is called a multi-function device because of its multi-tasking capabilities. But does multi-tasking mean the ability to perform many functions or the ability to perform those functions simultaneously. There are some products in the market that may offer multiple functions but may not deliver all of them concurrently. This may eventually result in higher downtimes due to bottlenecks. So beware!

5. Bi-directional communication capabilities: Good bi-directional communication across the network and at the device is essential to keep the workflow running smoothly. Any delay or disconnect in communicating accurate information on time can result in more intervention by the IT admin, further adding to his burden.

6. Vendor's long-term commitment: Before investing in an MFP, you should know what kind of device management, support and remote intelligence you will be offered. Do ensure the vendor's commitment to providing a robust device. One of the features to check is the device's relationship management software that helps in optimising its availability and uptime. You should look for a vendor who can provide superior response times and consistent quality of service. After all, to ensure a productive office, you must have your MFP up and running.

A few MFPs you could choose from



Xerox WorkCentre 7830, 7835, 7845 and 7855 MFPs

- All these devices offer 1200 x 2400 dpi, while advanced print heads with Digital Image Registration Control technology ensure precise control over colour matching.
- These MFPs print at speeds of up to 55 ppm and include a high-capacity feeder that holds 2,000 sheets of paper.
- They come with the 'Earth Smart' setting, helping businesses cut down on energy consumption with Xerox's EA Toner, which produces high quality images using less toner per page and requiring lower temperatures during printing.